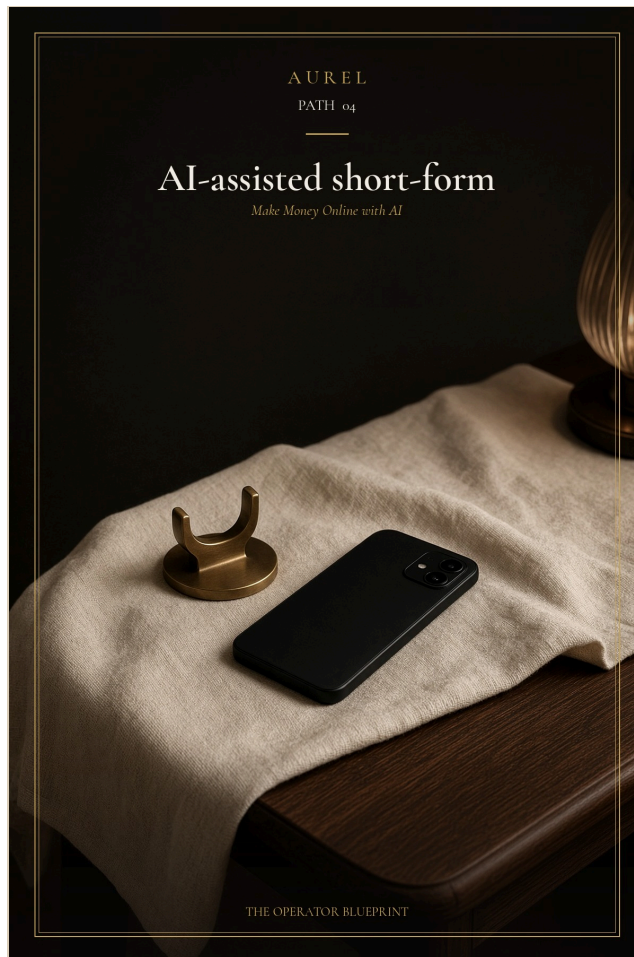




PATH 04

AI-assisted short-form

AI writes the outline. You say it. The offer sits at the end, every time.

36 minute read · 7,943 words

Who this is for

You can talk to a camera or screen-record, and you have one \$19 file to sell.

Time to first

14–30 days of posting on one platform

Tools

First sale

A profile visit that becomes an email or a \$19 checkout.

Cash window

Traffic to a \$19–\$47 file

Leave this alone

Phone, CapCut, one platform for 30 days, Stan or Beacons.

Five platforms. Faceless slideshows with no offer. Buying views.

What this actually is

Definition

AI-assisted short-form is 14 to 30 days of posting on one platform so a profile visit becomes an email or a \$19 checkout. Every video does one of three things: teach a small piece, diagnose a mistake, or send them to the next step. If it does none of those, it is entertainment you are not getting paid for. The offer sits at the end, every time. Same offer. Same link in the bio. You already have one thing to sell — a playbook, a skill pack, a prompt stack, an SOP. Short-form is how strangers find it.

This path is not "become a creator." It is a 30-day posting job with a file at the other end of the tap. AI writes the outline. You say it. That split is the whole method.

What this is not

Not five platforms. Not buying views. Not a 20-second tour of your whole catalog. Not waiting for the algorithm to "pick you" before you put a link in the bio. Not a faceless slideshow of quotes with no offer. Not a 3-minute origin story. Not a content business that sells the videos. The videos are the tap. The file is the drink.

You do not post AI voiceover over stock clips and call it a business. If you will not show your face, screen-record the work. Either way, a human says the words. The algorithm is not the bottleneck. Volume of honest posts is.

Why it works now

Short-form still sends strangers to a bio faster than a blog post. The window is not "go viral." The window is: a tired person watches 20 seconds of a job they recognize, hears a price, taps a link. That loop still works in 2026 because most accounts either have no offer, or they have seven

offers, or they read a press-release script. One file, spoken in a kitchen voice, at the end of every clip, is rare enough to convert.

AI is useful for hooks and outlines because staring at a blank notes app is how people skip a day. Generate twenty hooks. Speak the three you would actually say to a friend. Cut the rest. The model is a starter. You are the voice. Watchers can smell a paste. They came for a person who does the job.

Anti-pattern 1: five platforms to be safe

TikTok plus Instagram plus Shorts plus LinkedIn plus Pinterest in week 1 is how you stay at video three forever. Each app has a slightly different shape. You will spend the month on resizing and captions and never learn which five shapes earn saves. One platform for 30 days. After a stranger buys, remix the winners. Not before.

Anti-pattern 2: faceless slideshows with no offer

Silent carousels of quotes, stock footage, a caption that says "follow for more." That is a hobby with better lighting. If you screen-record the SOP and speak, that is not a slideshow. If you hide because you hate your face, use the screen. The offer still sits at the end. Faceless with no file is in the leave-alone line on purpose.

Anti-pattern 3: buying views

A cheap view on a video with no offer still converts to zero. Paid traffic before you know which shape a stranger watched is how you buy tourists. Creator ads with AI scripts is a later path, after a stranger has bought from organic posts. Do not jump-start a 30-day test with a credit card.

The deal you keep

You keep four promises. One: one platform for 30 days. Two: one file in the bio, price spoken at the end of every video. Three: AI outlines, you say it, in a voice you would use in a kitchen. Four: you read comments and turn objections into next week's scripts. The watcher keeps one promise in return: if the job is theirs, they know the next step without thinking. Same words, every time, so people who watch three videos can name the file.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

Fits if

You can talk to a camera or screen-record, and you have one thing to sell. You do not need to like how you look. You need to be willing to post 30 times on one app without switching when a post dies. You already have the file, or you will have it in week 1 (a \$19 SOP is enough). Short-form without an offer is a hobby. Short-form with a \$19 to \$47 file is this path.

You can batch two hours on a weekend. You can fix captions in CapCut. You can say "\$19" out loud without flinching. You already open TikTok, Instagram, or YouTube at night, which is how you pick the room.

Skip if

Skip if you will not press record. Skip if you planned to run five apps "to be safe." Skip if you want to buy views or followers. Skip if you have no file and no email capture — then go write the playbook, the SOP, or the prompt stack first.

If you freeze on camera, screen-record the job: the SOP, the prompt, the before/after. Your voice on the work is enough. If you will not even do that, this path will punish you for 30 days and then you will quit.

Skip if you need a sale tomorrow. This path names 14 to 30 days of posting. First stranger checkout often lands in week 2 or 3, after a handful of shapes have been seen twice. If you need cash this week, take a service job, then come back with the notes as the file.

The honest middle

Shy is allowed. Inconsistent is not. One platform, one offer, 30 days. That is the deal. You do not need a ring light, a brand kit, or a nice wall. You need a quiet room, a window, a phone, and a file that exists at checkout before video 1.

If you have two products, pick the \$19 one for 30 days. The other can wait. If you have zero products, this is not your first path this month.

Skills and time

You need: a phone that records, CapCut or the phone's trim and captions, a Stan or Beacons link, one file live, and the willingness to post on ugly days. You do not need editing skill beyond a trim and on-screen text. You do not need a following.

Time with a job: one two-hour batch on Sunday (seven to ten clips), then 10 minutes a weekday to post, pin a comment, and save objections. Thirty days on the calendar, including the days you do not feel like it. If you miss a day, post two the next. Do not restart on Monday.

Two-minute self-test

Answer out loud. Stall on two and this is not your first path this month.

What is the one file, in one line, with a price?

Which one app do you already open at night?

Can you film three 20-second videos this week: a mistake, a principle, a walkthrough?

Will you say "\$19, link in bio" at the end of all three?

If a post dies on day 4, will you still post on day 5 on the same app?

Is the checkout tested on your phone, on cellular?

If you have the file, the app, and the willingness to post 30 times, start. If you only have "I should be on TikTok," go ship the \$19 SOP first.

The watcher on the other side

They are not a fan. They are a person who does the job, watching muted on a couch. They will read the on-screen text, hear a kitchen voice if the sound is on, and decide in 20 seconds whether the file is for them. They will not hunt a menu. They will tap a bio that names one job and one price, or they will scroll.

The offer, named in one sentence

Fill this before you film

"Every video I post on [one platform] teaches one piece of [named job] and ends with [file name], \$19, link in bio, even if I hate how I look on camera."

If you cannot fill the brackets, you do not have an offer. You have a content hobby. The bio is the offer. Not a menu. Not "links, courses, coaching, merch." One file, one price, one link (Stan or Beacons).

Five sentences that already work

Every Instagram video teaches one piece of Friday follow-up for solo service people and ends with the 1-page SOP, \$19, link in bio.

Every TikTok shows one mistake in pediatric clinic SMS and ends with the 25-prompt stack, \$19, link in bio.

Every Short walks through one step of a landscaper's 10-day content playbook and ends with the \$29 file, link in bio.

Every Reel is a 90-second timer of filling a Notion calendar, then "the filled template is \$19, link in bio."

Every clip diagnoses one fake-sounding AI email, then points at the follow-up skill pack, \$19, same link.

Write yours in that shape. One platform. One job. One file. One price. Spoken at the end. If you need "and my course and my coaching" to feel complete, you made the bio a junk drawer.

What they get

They get 20 seconds of a job they recognize, on-screen text if they watch muted, a spoken price, and a bio that matches the end card. They get the same checkout every time. Teach a piece of the SOP, diagnose a mistake the SOP prevents, or walk through one step. Last line, spoken: "The file is \$19. Link in bio." Same words, every time.

This path does not sell the videos. It sells traffic to a \$19 to \$47 file. If you have nothing at checkout, you are posting for free.

What they do not get

A catalog. A live Q&A in week 1. A custom critique in DMs. A second product "while I have you." A community. A 3-minute origin. A free file that is only a sales letter. They get one next step. If they DM "can you just do this for me," that is a service path with a price, not a free consulting hour inside a comment thread.

Packaging

Bio: one line plus the link. Example: "The 1-page [job] SOP. \$19. I post how I use it." Pin comment on every post: "SOP is \$19. Link in bio." End card, spoken, last two seconds: "The file is \$19. Link in bio. One job, not a catalog." Caption: one sentence that repeats the hook, then the price. Three hashtags at most if the platform is picky, none if it is not.

Put the file up before day 1 of posting, even if it is ugly. You can pretty it later. You cannot retrofit an offer onto 30 videos with no link.

What "done" looks like

Definition

Done after 30 days is thirty posts on one platform, the same offer at the end, comments read, five shapes kept, and at least one profile visit that became an email or a \$19 checkout. That is the first sale this path names. Done after 72 hours is smaller: one platform, bio live, checkout tested, three videos filmed, one posted, five more batched, twenty hooks on a note.

Done is not a viral post with no link. Done is not a second platform "because this one is dead." Done is boring on purpose: volume, one file, one place.

Fairness test

Would you send a friend to your bio and trust they can name the file and the price in five seconds? If the bio is a menu, it is not fair. If the last two seconds of the video do not name the file and the price, the video failed even if it performed. If checkout is broken on cellular, nothing else is fair. Ask two watchers what they thought you sold. If they cannot name the file, your end card failed.

Technical done (72 hours)

One platform chosen. One-line offer in the bio. Checkout works on your phone. Three 20-second videos filmed (a mistake, a principle, a walkthrough). One posted today. Five more batched or scheduled. Twenty hooks on a note, three of them spoken in your mouth. On-screen text on all three. End card words decided and reused. Pin comment ready to paste.

Technical done (30 days)

Thirty posts on that one platform. Same offer at the end. At least five scripts taken from objections. Five shapes that got saves or comments, kept. The rest, retired. Captions fixed so the \$19 line is spelled right. At least one profile visit that became an email or a \$19 checkout. You asked that buyer which video they watched.

Not-done-yet list

No file at checkout

Bio is a menu

Price never spoken

No on-screen text

AI outline read word for word

Second platform opened because a post died

Offer changed in week 2

Zero batches, so every morning is a negotiation

Comments unread

Pin comment missing

Link untested on cellular

A 20-second catalog of three products

If three of those are true, you are posting, not running this path. Fix the list this week. Do not film video 41 until the bio and the end card are honest.

Pricing that holds

Ranges

You are not selling a "content package." You are pointing at a \$19 to \$47 file. \$19 SOP is the cleanest first product for this path. \$29 to \$47 if the file already has templates. Do not launch a \$97 cohort from a 20-second clip. The clip cannot hold that weight yet. Stay in the cash window: traffic to a \$19 to \$47 file.

Say "\$19" out loud at the end. People who will never buy still respect a number. People who might buy should not have to DM you to hear it. Pin a comment with the next step if the platform allows it: "SOP is \$19. Link in bio."

When to raise

Raise the file after a stranger has bought from organic posts and you have added something they used: a second template, a 14-day calendar, the three scripts they asked for. Then \$19 can become \$29 or \$47. Do not raise because a video got views. Views are not revenue. Do not raise by adding a \$97 "mentorship" in week 3. The 20-second clip still cannot hold it.

Refunds in one sentence

If it is not useful, email me and I will refund. I will not hop on a call to recap the SOP.

You will refund almost nobody if chapter one or prompt 1 works. You will refund the person who thought the video was the product. Make the end card clearer.

Never charge for these

Never charge for views you bought. Never charge a "content audit" in DMs as a way to avoid posting. Never charge for the videos themselves in month one. Never hide the price behind "link in bio, DM me." Never run ads until a stranger has bought organic and you know which shape they watched.

Worked dollars

Jordan has a one-page SOP at \$19. They post 30 times on Instagram. Views are uneven. Two posts do nothing. One 90-second timer walkthrough gets saves. A stranger buys on day 18 from the bio after watching the timer video and the three-paragraph diagnosis. \$19. Jordan asks what they watched. They say the timer. That shape becomes the next five posts. Two more checkouts in week 4, same file. Month 1: \$57 from the bio, zero ad spend, one platform. That is the path. Not a creator career. Traffic to a \$19 file.

The first 72 hours

Day 1 morning: pick the room and the line

Pick one platform. TikTok, Instagram, or YouTube Shorts — not all three. If you already spend time watching one of those apps, post there. Do not pick the "serious" platform you never open. Write the one-line offer that every video can point to. Put it in the bio with Stan or Beacons. Test the link on your phone, on cellular. If the file is not live, stop and ship a \$19 SOP today. Do not film into a dead checkout.

Day 1 afternoon: 20 hooks, then three you would say

Generate 20 hooks. Speak only the lines you would say to a friend. Paste this, then cut anything that sounds like a press release:

Give me 20 spoken hooks for a 20-second video. Buyer: [person]. File I sell: [SOP name], \$19. Each hook is one sentence I would say in a kitchen. Pattern: "Stop doing [common thing] if you want [result]." No hype. No "wait for it." No hashtags in the hook.

Circle three. Write a one-line body for each: the mistake, the principle, or the walkthrough. The last two seconds are already decided: "The file is \$19. Link in bio. One job, not a catalog."

Day 1 night: film three, post one

Film three 20-second videos: a mistake, a principle, a walkthrough. Phone on a stack of books. Window light. Same wall is fine. On-screen text for mute. Same end card. Post one today. Do not

wait until Monday. Do not buy a ring light. Do not open a second account. Do not design a brand kit. The algorithm is not the bottleneck. Volume of honest posts is.

Day 2: captions, pin, batch folder

CapCut auto-captions, then fix names and the \$19 line. Wrong captions kill trust. Pin the comment: "SOP is \$19. Link in bio." Put the other two videos in a folder named by day. Read any comments. Save objections into a note. If you have no comments yet, that is normal. You have one post.

Day 3: batch the next five

Two hours. Five more clips. Same shirt is fine. Same three types on a loop. You do not need a fourth type. Export, schedule or dump into the folder. Publish one a day starting today if you have not already. That is the 72 hours. Do not check analytics for more than five minutes. You do not have enough posts to learn anything yet.

The path, step by step

Step 1. One offer in the bio

Not a menu. Stan or Beacons, one button, one file. If you have two products, pick the \$19 one for 30 days. The other can wait. Test the link on cellular. If you cannot name the file in one line, you do not have an offer. Go back to Sell an AI playbook or AI templates and SOPs and ship the file, then return.

Step 2. A hook formula, spoken in the first second

"Stop doing [common thing] if you want [result]." Then show the better way in 15 seconds. The hook is spoken in the first second, also on-screen for people who watch muted. Other patterns that fit: "If your [artifact] looks like this, that is why [bad result]." "I timed this. [N] seconds. Then I sent it." Generate 20. Speak three.

Step 3. Pick one picture style for 30 days

Your face or your screen. Keep it. Switching from talking-head to slideshow to car-vlog trains nobody, including you. On-screen text always, for muted watchers. Lighting can be a window. Audio can be the phone mic in a quiet room.

Step 4. Batch. Two hours, ten videos

Two hours, ten videos, beats ten days of "I should post." Phone on a stack of books. Same shirt is fine. Same wall is fine. CapCut to add captions. Export, schedule or dump into a folder named by day. If you negotiate with yourself every morning, you will skip. The batch is how you stay on the 30-day clock.

Step 5. Read comments. Objections are next week's scripts

Paste them into a note, then into AI for outlines, then rewrite. "This is too simple" becomes a video that shows the mistake of overbuilding. "I do not have time" becomes a 20-second timer of you doing one step. If you have no comments yet, film the three objections you already believe: too simple, no time, I could do this myself.

Step 6. Pin a comment with the next step

"SOP is \$19. Link in bio. One job, not a catalog." Do this on every post for 30 days so you are not relying on people to read a tiny bio. If the platform does not allow pins, put the same line as the first comment you post yourself.

Step 7. Loop the three types

A mistake, a principle, a walkthrough. You do not need a fourth type in month one. Variety is how people stall. Week 3 you will repeat the two shapes that got saves. That is not boring. That is how a stranger sees the file twice and buys.

Step 8. End card, spoken, every time

"The file is \$19. Link in bio. One job, not a catalog." Same words. Boredom here is a feature. Recognition is the point. If the last two seconds do not name the file and the price, the video failed the bar even if it performed.

Step 9. Fix captions so the \$19 line is spelled right

CapCut auto-captions, then a 15-minute pass per batch. Wrong captions kill trust. Names, prices, and the job word must be correct. Phone tools are enough if CapCut annoys you.

Step 10. Post one a day. Missed days get doubled, not restarted

If you miss a day, post two the next. Do not "restart on Monday." The 30-day clock includes the ugly days. You have a job; batch on the weekend so weekdays are just tap-post.

Step 11. After 30, keep five shapes, kill the rest

Saves and comments beat views. Views without saves are tourists. Repeat the five that earned saves, with new examples. Ask the first buyer which video they watched. That shape is the spine of the next 30.

Step 12. Do not switch platforms when a post dies

Dead posts are normal. Switching is how you stay at video three forever. Five platforms is in the leave-alone line. After a stranger buys, you may remix the five winning shapes onto a second app. Not before.

Step 13. Do not explain your whole catalog in 20 seconds

If you name three products, they will buy none. One job. One price. One link. Jordan did not mention the other files. You should not either.

Step 14. Screen-record if you will not show a face

Your voice on the SOP is enough. Faceless slideshows with no offer are how people post for months and sell nothing. The offer still sits at the end. Do not use AI voice if you can say the line. It usually sounds like a press release.

Step 15. After a stranger buys, ask what they watched

Write it down. Make the next five posts that shape with new examples. Do not start TikTok on day 19. Do not change the offer. The first-sale definition is a profile visit that became an email or

a \$19 checkout. Protect that loop.

Step 16. Stop adding gear and channels

No microphone haul in the first 30. No second letter. No membership announced from a 20-second clip. A quiet room and a window. Spend after a stranger checkout if audio was the actual complaint. Plan the next 30 only after a stranger has bought or you have 30 honest posts, whichever comes first.

A worked example

Jordan, one platform, 30 days, \$19 SOP

Jordan has a one-page SOP: "Friday follow-up for solo service people" — a sequence they already use to email clients who went quiet. Price: \$19. They pick Instagram. They do not open TikTok "as well." Bio: "Friday follow-up SOP. \$19. I show the steps here." Link: Stan. Checkout tested on cellular. File is a PDF, ugly, usable.

They generate 20 hooks. They speak three:

Stop rewriting the same "just checking in" email every Friday if you want people to actually reply.

If your follow-up is three paragraphs, they are not ignoring you. They are tired.

I time this. One client, 90 seconds, send. The SOP is \$19.

Calendar: days 1 to 30

Day 1, morning: bio and Stan live. Afternoon: 20 hooks, three circled. Night: three films, one posted (the three-paragraph diagnosis). Day 2: captions fixed, pin comment, folder started. Day 3, Saturday: two-hour batch of seven more. Weekdays: tap-post one.

Week 1: seven videos, same offer. Three mistakes (the long email, the guilt tone, the missing next date), two principles (one ask, one next date), two walkthroughs (screen-record the SOP, fill it for a fake client). Analytics glance: under five minutes. Nothing to learn yet.

Week 2: comments become scripts. Someone says "this only works if you have a list." Jordan films: "You need three names, not a CRM." Someone says "AI emails sound fake." Jordan films the human pass: "Generate, then cut the smile." Seven more posts. Still Instagram only.

Week 3: repeat the two shapes that got saves — the 90-second timer and the "three paragraphs" diagnosis. Same words, new example (a photographer, then a bookkeeper). Two posts from week 1 did nothing. They stay dead. Jordan does not switch apps.

Week 4: one longer walkthrough (60 to 90 seconds) of filling the SOP, still pointing at the same \$19 checkout. No live. A longer screen-record counts. Keep posting the five shapes they are keeping.

The mistake and the recovery

On day 11 Jordan films a "value" clip that names three other files "while I have you." Saves drop. A comment says "so what do you actually sell?" Jordan deletes the catalog line from the next five scripts. End card goes back to one file, \$19. They pin the SOP comment on the catalog video so the damage is a confused bio tap, not a dead end. Recovery is same week, not a rebrand.

First stranger sale, dollars, shipped artifact

Views were uneven. A stranger bought on day 18 from the bio after watching the timer video and the three-paragraph video. \$19. Jordan asked what they watched. They said the timer. That became the next five posts. Two more checkouts in week 4: \$38. Month 1 cash: \$57. Shipped artifact on the video side: 30 posts, one style (face plus a few screen-records of the SOP), one end card, a note of objections. Shipped artifact on the product side: the same one-page PDF they already had. They did not start TikTok on day 19. They did not explain their other two file ideas in a 20-second clip. They posted the SOP, \$19, one platform.

Copy you can actually send

Swap the job. Keep the kitchen voice. Same end card every time.

Post (caption under the video)

Stop starting from a blank follow-up if you need a reply this Friday. SOP is \$19, link in bio.

DM when someone comments "link?"

Here: [link]. \$19, one page, instant. If it is not useful, email me and I will refund. I will not hop on a call to recap the SOP.

Page hero (bio)

The 1-page [job] SOP. \$19. I post how I use it.

Checkout (Stan or Beacons button)

[Job] SOP — one page, \$19. Instant download. If it is not useful, email me and I will refund.

Email 1 — they tapped the link but did not buy

Subject: The file from the 90-second video

You watched the timer. The SOP is the sequence I used in that clip. \$19. One page. [link] If that was the wrong job, delete this.

Email 2 — after they buy

Subject: Which video did you watch?

Thanks for grabbing the SOP. Reply with the video that sent you — the timer, the three-paragraph one, or something else. I will make more of that. If you trip on a step, tell me which line. I will fix the file.

Email 3 — day 20, still no stranger sale

Subject: Same file, same \$19, still one job

I have posted [N] times on [platform]. The SOP is still \$19. If you have been watching and have not grabbed it: [link]. If you already own it, reply with the line you actually sent. If this is noise, unsubscribe.

Refund

You asked for a refund. Here it is, no speech. If you thought the videos were the product, that is on my end card and I have made the \$19 file louder. You do not have to explain. The refund is processing.

Hook (spoken, first second)

Stop doing [common thing] if you want [result].

Other hooks that fit:

If your [artifact] looks like this, that is why [bad result].

I timed this. [N] seconds. Then I sent it.

Stop starting from a blank chat if you need [result] this week.

End card (spoken, last two seconds)

The file is \$19. Link in bio. One job, not a catalog.

Pin comment

SOP is \$19. Link in bio. If you want the [job] sequence without guessing, that is the file.

Week-by-week if you have a job

Assume evenings plus one weekend batch. Four weeks of posting, not a media company.

Week 1: 7 videos, same offer (daily)

Sunday or Monday, two hours: batch seven clips. Mistake, principle, walkthrough, repeat. Same end card.

Monday: post 1. Pin comment. Save the folder.

Tuesday: post 2. Read comments. Five minutes of analytics, then stop.

Wednesday: post 3.

Thursday: post 4.

Friday: post 5.

Saturday: post 6. If you are short, film two more in 20 minutes rather than skip.

Sunday: post 7. Batch the next seven if you can. Do not check analytics for more than five minutes. You do not have enough posts to learn anything yet.

Week 2: 7 more, comments become scripts (daily)

Monday: read every comment from week 1. Paste objections into a note.

Tuesday: generate outlines from those objections, rewrite, film three.

Wednesday through Sunday: post one a day. If you have no comments yet, film the three objections you already believe: too simple, no time, I could do this myself. Answer them in 20 seconds. Help first in any niche group you already belong to — not a dump of seven links.

Week 3: repeat winners

Look at saves and comments, not views. Repeat those shapes with new examples. Kill the clever ones nobody saved. Still one platform. Still \$19. Still the same end card. If you named three products in a clip, that clip is retired.

Week 4: one longer piece, same checkout

One live or one longer walkthrough pointing at the same checkout. If live terrifies you, a 60-second screen-record of the SOP filled in is enough. Then keep posting the five shapes you are keeping. Plan the next 30 only after a stranger has bought or you have 30 honest posts, whichever comes first. Do not add a Friday bonus account because you felt guilty about a dead post.

Quality bar

Below the bar

A press-release voice. "Smash that." AI outline read word for word. No on-screen text. No offer in the last two seconds. A menu in the bio. Faceless quotes. Bought views. Five platforms. A 20-second catalog. Hashtag stuffing instead of a pin comment. Checking views hourly. Starting over on Monday. A video that performed and still cannot name the file.

Above the bar

A voice you would use in a kitchen. If you would not say the line to a friend, cut it. AI outlines; you say it. On-screen text for mute. Face or screen, one style for 30 days. Offer spoken at the end. Price on the pin comment. Captions spell \$19 right. The watcher can name the file after three videos.

Test 1: the kitchen-table test

Play the clip out loud. If a line makes you wince, cut it. If you would not say "smash that" to a friend, do not say it here.

Test 2: the mute test

Watch with sound off. Can you still get the hook and the \$19? If not, on-screen text failed.

Test 3: the offer test

If the last two seconds do not name the file and the price, the video failed the bar even if it performed. Entertainment you are not getting paid for is the original warning. Put the offer on.

Test 4: the bio test

Hand your phone to someone who does not know you. Five seconds on the profile. Can they name the file and the price? If they say "you do a lot of things," the bio is a menu.

Test 5: the stranger-sale test

A profile visit became an email or a \$19 checkout. Ask which video they watched. If you have 40,000 views and zero taps, the bio or the end card is wrong. Fix those before you film video 41.

Metrics that matter (and vanity numbers to ignore)

Week 1

Count posts published (target 7), batch sessions (target 1), checkout self-test on cellular (yes/no), bio is one offer (yes/no), end card used on every clip (yes/no). Do not count followers. Do not count a view spike. You do not have enough posts to learn yet.

Day 30

Posts published (aim 7 a week, 30 in the window). Saves and comments, especially objections you can reuse. Profile visits. Link taps. Emails captured or \$19 checkouts from the bio. Which 5 shapes earned the saves. Which video the first buyer watched. A healthy day-30: 30 posts, one platform, one file, at least one profile visit that became an email or a checkout, five shapes ready to repeat.

Day 90

A second 30 on the same platform, repeating the five shapes. Remix of those five onto a second app only after a stranger bought. File still \$19 to \$47 unless you added something they used. Ad spend still \$0 unless organic already converted and you know the shape. If you have 90 posts and zero taps, the bio or the end card has been wrong for three months. Fix that, do not add a podcast.

Ignore these

Follower count as a goal. View spikes with no taps. Likes from people who will never buy. Completions on a video with no offer. How you look. Whether a stranger on the internet said you should try a different platform. Hashtag reach. "Impressions."

One-line spreadsheet

Columns: date, posts, saves, comments, profile visits, link taps, checkouts, which shape, notes (objection to reuse). One row a week. If checkouts stay zero while visits rise, the Stan page is the

bug. If visits stay zero, the end card or the hook is the bug. If posts stay under 5 a week, the batch is the bug. Fix the named bug. Do not switch apps to feel new.

Objections you will hear

"The algorithm hates me."

You have not posted 30 times. Post. Then look at saves, not at a theory about the algorithm. Switching platforms when a post dies is a listed mistake.

"I need to be on all five apps."

Five platforms is in the leave-alone line. One platform for 30 days. After a stranger buys, you can remix the five winning shapes onto a second app. Not before.

"Faceless is easier."

Faceless slideshows with no offer are how people hide. If you screen-record the work and speak, that is not a slideshow. If you post silent carousels of quotes, you are not on this path.

"I will buy views to jump-start."

Buying views is in the leave-alone line. You will get tourists and a fake sense of momentum. Organic posts that name a \$19 file convert. Paid views of a no-offer clip do not.

"I do not have anything to sell yet."

Then this is not your first path. Ship a \$19 SOP or playbook this week (Sell an AI playbook, AI templates and SOPs, Niche prompt stacks). Then post. Short-form without a file is a hobby with better lighting.

"I do not want to show my face."

Then screen-record the SOP. Your voice on the page is enough. The offer still sits at the end.

"I need more followers first."

You need a profile visit that becomes a checkout. Fifty of the right watchers beat 5,000 tourists. Do not buy followers. Post the next one.

"I do not have time."

Two hours on Sunday, ten clips. Weekdays are tap-post. If you cannot find two hours this month, this path will wait. Do not post one heroic video and disappear.

"AI voice is fine, it sounds professional."

It sounds like a press release. This path wants you to say it. If you cannot, screen-record plus your voice is the backup. AI voice plus stock clips is how you blend into the leftover pile.

"Nothing sold after 30 posts."

Check, in order: is the file live, is the price spoken, is the link working, is the bio one offer. Then look at the 5 shapes with saves. Repeat those. Ask two watchers what they thought you sold. If they cannot name the file, your end card failed.

How this feeds other paths

Upstream: what you need before this

A \$19 to \$47 file that exists at checkout. Sell an AI playbook, Niche prompt stacks, Ship a Claude or ChatGPT skill pack, AI templates and SOPs — any one file. Short-form is the tap. The file is the drink. If you have no file, this path is a hobby. Ship the file in week 1, then post.

Downstream: what you are driving traffic to

The same checkout for 30 days. Your front door can sit in the bio later: a diagnostic, email required, then the file. Not in week 1 if a Stan checkout already works. A weekly AI letter can catch people who are not ready to buy: "email for the 7-question score" as a second button only after the \$19 is converting.

What the comments become

Objections become A weekly AI letter. Walkthroughs become Long-form explainers. The winning hook becomes Creator ads with AI scripts when you are ready to pay for traffic — after a stranger has bought organic. Live drops of AI packs can be announced in the same 20-second end card.

What you do not feed yet

A small AI membership, a catalog, a coaching call. Thirty days, one file. Local businesses + AI can use the same clips as proof you can make simple videos for a nearby owner, billed as a service. That is extra, not the 30-day job.

Mistakes that kill this path

1. Posting with no offer

Recovery this week: put the \$19 file live, rewrite the bio to one line, add the end card to every clip going forward. Do not unpublish 30 videos. Pin the comment on the ones that already exist.

2. Switching platforms when a post dies

Recovery this week: stay. Post tomorrow on the same app. Dead posts are normal.

3. Using a voice you would not use in a kitchen

Recovery this week: re-record the next three with the kitchen test. Throw out "smash that" and the AI outline you were reading.

4. Buying followers or views

Recovery this week: turn the ads off. Count organic taps only. Do not buy a "boost" to soothe a dead post.

5. Explaining your whole catalog in 20 seconds

Recovery this week: one job, one price, one link. Retire the catalog clip. Pin the SOP on it.

6. Waiting for a better microphone

Recovery this week: film in a quiet room by a window. Gear is not the 30-day job.

7. Batching zero videos

Recovery this week: two hours, ten clips, this weekend. Weekdays become tap-post.

8. Changing the offer in week 2

Recovery this week: go back to the \$19 file. The other idea waits until a stranger has bought this one.

9. Reading the AI outline word for word

Recovery this week: generate hooks, speak three, throw the rest away. If a line makes you wince on playback, cut it.

10. Hashtag stuffing instead of a pin comment

Recovery this week: three tags at most, pin "SOP is \$19. Link in bio."

11. Checking views hourly

Recovery this week: one five-minute glance after post 7, post 14, post 30. Saves and comments, not views.

12. Starting over on Monday

Recovery this week: post the missed ones today. The 30 includes messy weeks.

Ethics, restated

Do not fake a testimonial in a talking-head. Do not use a client's real email on screen. Do not buy a comment pod. Do not scrape someone else's hooks and swap the niche word. The kitchen voice includes not lying.

Tools and how you actually use them

Exact stack

Phone. Front camera or screen record. CapCut for captions and a trim. One platform for 30 days: TikTok, Instagram, or YouTube Shorts. Stan or Beacons in the bio, one button, the \$19 to \$47 file. A notes app for hooks and objections. That is the original tools line. No extra apps in week 1.

Setup order

File live at checkout. Stan or Beacons button tested on cellular. Bio written as one line plus the link. 20 hooks generated, three spoken. Three videos filmed. CapCut captions fixed. Post one. Pin comment. Folder for the rest. Then batch. Do not build a desktop pipeline until you have 30 posts. Do not pick the platform you never open.

What not to buy

A ring light if your phone camera works. A microphone in the first 30. A second phone. A scheduler that costs more than the file. Ads. Followers. A brand kit. Five extra apps. A teleprompter so you can read the AI outline. Creator ads tools. Those belong to a later path.

The \$0 path

Phone you already own. Free CapCut or the phone's own captions. Instagram, TikTok, or Shorts account you already have. A free Stan or Beacons plan, or a Stripe Payment Link in the bio if that is what you already use. Window light. Quiet room. The \$19 file can be a Google Doc exported to PDF. You do not need a new domain for month one.

How you actually film

Phone on a stack of books, camera at eye line if it is your face, or screen record of the SOP. First second is the hook, also on-screen. Fifteen seconds of the job. Two seconds of offer. Export 9:16. If the first second is sharp enough to read on mute, you passed.

Ship checklist

Print this. Tick it. Do not post video 1 until the offer half is honest.

Before you post video 1

- One file live at \$19 to \$47
- Checkout tested on your phone, on cellular
- One platform chosen (the one you already open)
- Bio is one line plus the link
- 20 hooks generated; three you would actually say
- Three videos filmed: mistake, principle, walkthrough
- End card words decided and reused
- On-screen text on all three
- CapCut captions fixed, \$19 spelled right
- Pin comment text ready
- Folder named by day for the batch

Every posting day

- On-screen text for mute
- Offer spoken at the end
- Pin comment with the \$19 next step
- Captions checked
- Comments read and saved into a note
- No second platform
- No catalog in 20 seconds

After 30

- Keep 5 shapes (saves and comments)

Kill the rest

Do not switch platforms

Ask the first buyer which video they watched

Spreadsheet row: posts, saves, taps, checkouts, shape

File still the same \$19 unless they asked for more

Ads still off until a stranger bought organic

FAQ

Which platform?

The one you already open. TikTok, Instagram, or YouTube Shorts. Not all three. If you do not open any of them, this path will feel like homework. Pick Instagram if you hate TikTok's tone. Pick Shorts if you already lurk on YouTube. Then stay. Default: the app you already open at night.

Face or screen?

Pick one for 30 days. Face if you can talk. Screen if the product is the SOP or the prompt. Mixing both every other day is how you never get a recognizable shape. Default: screen-record the work if you freeze on camera; face if you can talk for 20 seconds.

How long is a video?

20 seconds is the default. 15 seconds of teaching, 2 seconds of offer. A week-4 walkthrough can be 60 seconds. Do not start at 3 minutes. Default: 20 seconds.

What if I miss a day?

Post two the next day. Do not restart the 30. The clock includes messy weeks. Batch on the weekend so weekdays are just tap-post. Default: double up, do not reset.

Do I need CapCut Pro?

No. Captions and a trim. Phone tools are enough if CapCut annoys you. Default: free CapCut or the phone editor.

Can I use AI voice?

You can, and it usually sounds like a press release. This path wants you to say it. Screen-record plus your voice is the backup if you will not show a face. Default: your voice.

What if nothing sells after 30 posts?

Check, in order: is the file live, is the price spoken, is the link working, is the bio one offer. Then look at the 5 shapes with saves. Repeat those. Ask two watchers what they thought you sold. If they cannot name the file, your end card failed. Default: fix bio and end card before video 31.

Should I buy a microphone and lights?

Not in the first 30. A quiet room and a window. Spend after a stranger checkout if audio was the complaint. Default: no gear haul.

Can I post the same video on two platforms?

Not as a way to skip the 30 on one. After 30, remix the five winners. During the 30, one room. Default: one platform.

Is this the same as Creator ads with AI scripts?

No. This is organic posting to a \$19 file. Creator ads is paid traffic later, with scripts, after you know which shape converts. Do not run ads to a video you posted twice. Default: ads off until a stranger bought organic.

What if I hate my face on camera?

Screen-record the SOP. Your voice on the page is enough. Default: screen plus voice, still one style for 30 days.

Do I need a hook every time?

Yes. Spoken in the first second, also on-screen. Default: "Stop doing [common thing] if you want [result]."

Can I change the \$19 file in week 2?

No. One file for 30 days. The other idea waits. Default: stay.

How many hashtags?

Three at most if the platform is picky, none if it is not. A pin comment beats a tag list. Default: pin comment, almost no tags.

What if comments are mean?

Steal the useful objection. Ignore the heat. Do not film a Tuesday about your feelings unless that is the job you sell. Default: save the useful line, skip the rest.

Should I go live in week 1?

No. Week 4, one longer walkthrough, only if you want. A 60-second screen-record counts. Default: no live required.

Can I use someone else's trending audio?

You can. Do not let the audio bury the hook or the \$19. Default: your voice first, trend second, never instead of the offer.